Valve Inventory

Upgrade Guide

How to move from an older installed version to a newer one - say, v1.2 to v1.3 - without losing anything you've added. This is a living document: the general procedure below applies to every release so far and is expected to keep applying, but check “Version-specific notes” at the end for anything a particular release calls out as different.

The short answer

No, it isn't export-and-reimport. All of your data - stock, box locations, confirmed parameters, everything - lives in one file, `valves.db`, and upgrading never touches that file directly. Back it up (below), get the new version's code, and run it against your existing database. That's the whole procedure.

> **Note:** This works because every schema change so far has been strictly additive - new tables only, created with `CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS`, never a renamed or removed column. The app rebuilds its schema against your existing database on every single startup (`V.init_db()`) - on an up-to-date database that's a no-op; on one from an older version, it just adds whatever tables are new, in place, and leaves everything already there untouched.

1. Back up first - always

Do this before touching anything else. Two options, and it's fine to do both:

Copy the file (fastest, most robust)

Copy `valves.db` itself to somewhere safe - another folder, a dated backup folder, cloud storage, a USB stick. If you've built a local datasheet archive, copy the `datasheets/` folder too (optional - it's rebuildable, just slower to redo than to copy).

Refresh the text snapshot

```
python3 snapshot.py
```

Writes a human-readable copy into `data/` - good to have regardless, and if you track your own fork in git, commit it so you have real version history of your collection, not just a single backup snapshot.

2. Get the new version

If you're on a git clone

```
git fetch --tags
git checkout v1.3          # or: git pull, to track main instead of a tag
```

`valves.db` is gitignored, so neither command touches it - only the code and docs update. Nothing further to do for the database itself.

If you're using a downloaded copy (no git)

Download the new release and extract it to a **new** folder - don't extract over the old one. Then copy your existing `valves.db` (and `datasheets/`, if you have one, and anything under `docs/screenshots/` you added yourself) from the old folder into the new one.

3. Run it

```
python3 valves_gui.py
```

First launch against the upgraded code creates any new tables the new version needs, against your existing data, automatically. You should see your full collection immediately - same counts, same boxes, same confirmed parameters.

4. Confirm nothing's missing

```
python3 test_smoke.py
```

Then Tools > Collection summary (or `python3 valves.py stats`) and check the totals match what you expect. If anything looks off, your backup from step 1 is right there.

Optionally, refresh the snapshot again now that you're upgraded, so `data/` reflects the current version's schema too:

```
python3 snapshot.py
```

What not to do

> **Note:** Don't run `snapshot.py --restore` as part of upgrading. That rebuilds `valves.db` FROM the last-committed `data/valves.sql` - which discards anything you've added to your live database since the last time you ran plain `snapshot.py`. It's the right tool for a fresh clone that has no database yet at all (see the Installation Manual), not for upgrading one you already have.

Version-specific notes

Nothing beyond the standard procedure above has ever been required. Entries below are added only if a future release ever needs something different - if there's nothing here for the version you're moving to, the standard procedure is all you need.

v1.3

Adds one new table (`document` - extra datasheets, links, and the general reference library) and a Docs tab. Purely additive, created automatically on first run - no manual steps.

v1.1 - v1.2

v1.1 added an auto-restore prompt for a brand-new database with no `valves.db` yet; irrelevant if you're upgrading an existing one. No schema changes. (There was no separate v1.2 release.)